

and material that gives comfort, unlike the leatherite copies. And why the perfectly polished wood should not have an anti-scratch layer because touching the natural grains of wood is good for human health while the coating can give off volatile organic compounds. A little bit of elbow grease and polish helps retain that perfection." These elements make for perfect luxury.

A retiring CEO in Bengaluru was spending upwards of ₹30 crore to buy a home from White Lotus Developers. He was an avid traveller and collected curios from around the world. As he decided to settle down to enjoy his riches, he wanted the beauty and opulence to shine through.

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AVAN KUMAR, CEO of White Lotus Developers, says setting up the framework in which the luxury interiors can be crafted is

done during the development phase itself. The feeling of space must come through in rooms, kitchens, bathrooms and even ceiling heights. His design process takes a year. Customisation in layouts is offered even during completion. So, when the villa was under construction, the CEO asked for a pride of place in the living space for his mother's musical instrument, the *veena*, Kumar went out of his way to design the space. "We even speak to all family members together to accommodate their multiple wants," says Kumar.

Mayank Ruia of MAIA Estates, which is present in Bengaluru and Chennai, says, "It is the last 20-30% that makes the difference between the good and the best. Today developers such as MAIA allow designers in at the last stages of interiors so that the final finish can be in line with the designer's specification." Design teams even guide the buyer in the journey while the facilities team helps him settle in.

"If you have wealth, let it flow through the interiors, is the new mantra," says New Delhi-based designer duo, Rachna Mehra and daughter Devika Mehra of Bonarte. "Luxury begins at the main door, when there is enough space. Cars and motor bikes



RACHNA MEHRA AND DAUGHTER DEVIKA MEHRA of Bonarte design luxe living spaces in several cities, including Hyderabad and Chennai. For them "luxury begins at the main door, when there is enough space"

